Commission on Indian Currency and Finance), which was appointed in August 1925 to examine and report on the Indian exchange and currency system and of which Purshotamdas was an important member, made recommendations on the monetary standard (gold bullion standard), the exchange rate of the rupee (it recommended stabilizing the rupee at 1s 6d), and the establishment of a central bank which was to be called the Reserve Bank of India. Purshotamdas disagreed with some of the more important recommendations of the majority report of the Commission and submitted a Minute of dissent in which he argued for a 1s 6d ratio, a genuine gold standard (rather than the gold exchange standard proposed by the majority), and aired his views on the evolution of the proposed central bank from the Imperial Bank rather than the establishment of a new institution. The latter part of this narrative also takes note of some of the politics which took place behind the scenes to prevent Purshotamdas from submitting his Minute of dissent.

When Purshotamdas returned to India from England after the report of the Commission was finalized, he launched a vigorous campaign against the 1s 6d ratio. In an interesting incident, the government tried to spy on Purshotamdas and his colleagues when they met at his residence in New Delhi to muster support against the move to introduce the 1s 6d ratio through legislation. Another incident in which an agent, in reality a government official masquerading as a cash-for-votes agent, tried to convince G.D. Birla that he could muster six votes in favour of the 1s 4d ratio if he was paid a certain sum of money, also finds mention. In 1929, the government appointed the ICBEC of which Purshotamdas was the Vice Chairman (and also the acting Chairman in the absence of Sir B.N. Mitra). The monumental report made recommendations on a wide variety of subjects. Apart from seeing the problems of the banking industry with clarity, it was also a rich source of economic data.

Purshotamdas also took part in the deliberations of the second and third Round Table Conferences in London. He was a member of the Federal Structure Sub-committee at the second Round Table Conference and was also involved with informal discussions on economic and political issues, the burning issue at the time being the financial impact on India as a result of Britain going off the gold standard, and the government’s decision to link the rupee to sterling. Purshotamdas’s most important contribution at the